Ageing WIP & Service Level Expectation

See how old each open item is compared with how long work usually takes, and act before it's late.

Manage Flow · Work Item Age · Cycle Time Percentiles · Service Level Expectation

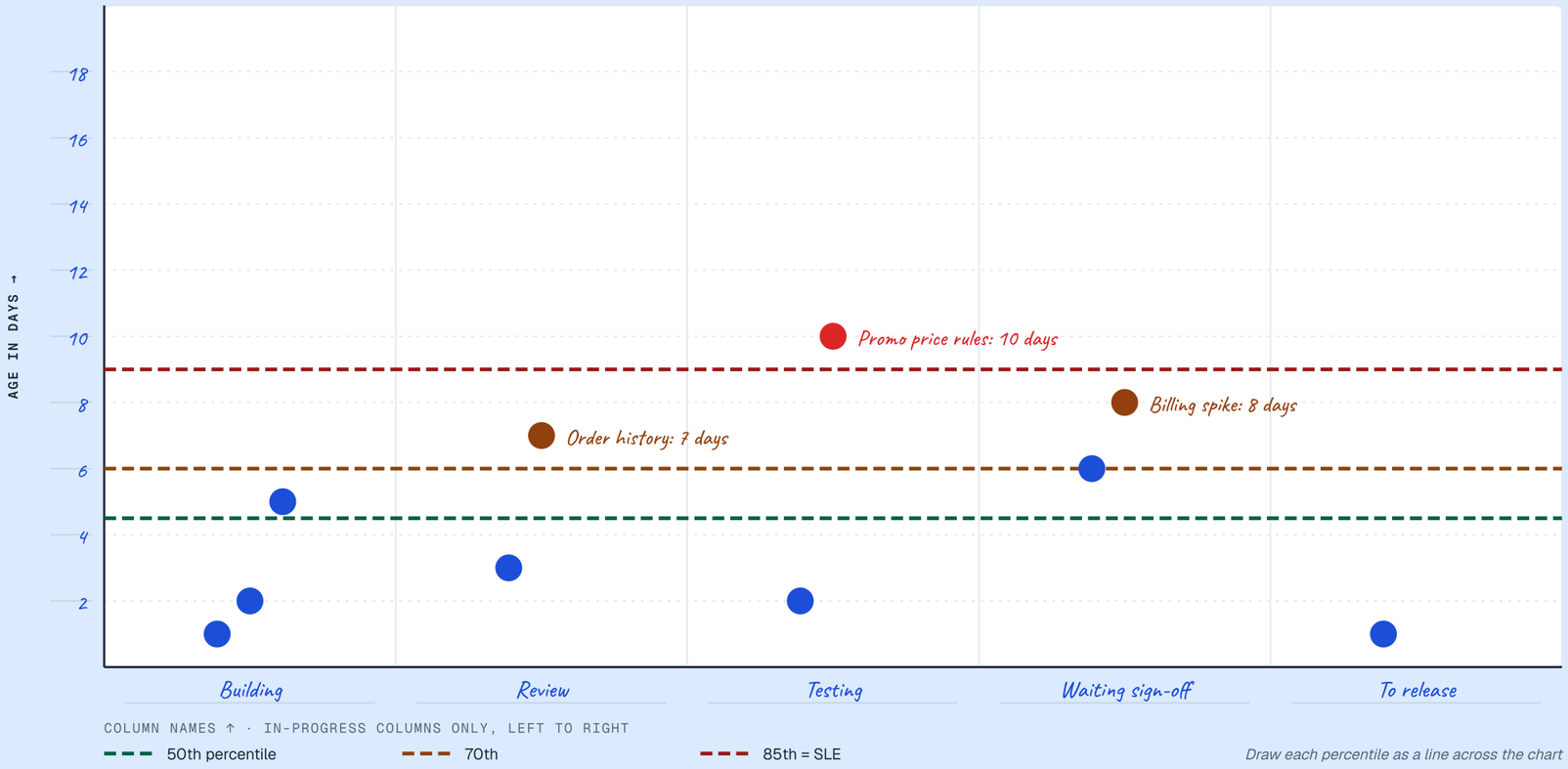
WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket team

DATE: 9 May

1 Ageing WIP Chart

ONE DOT PER OPEN ITEM, IN ITS CURRENT COLUMN



COLUMN NAMES ↑ · IN-PROGRESS COLUMNS ONLY, LEFT TO RIGHT

50th percentile · 70th · 85th = SLE

Draw each percentile as a line across the chart

2 Cycle Time Data

RECENTLY FINISHED ITEMS

ITEM	STARTED	FINISHED	DAYS
Last-order card	3 Mar	6 Mar	3
Reorder button	5 Mar	12 Mar	5
Flag unavailable	17 Mar	21 Mar	4
Email confirmation	18 Mar	20 Mar	2
Reorder events	24 Mar	1 Apr	6
Order history	31 Mar	10 Apr	9
Copy test data	7 Apr	10 Apr	3
Price-change tag	14 Apr	18 Apr	4
Favourites API	22 Apr	30 Apr	7
Out-of-stock rules	14 Apr	30 Apr	12

50th percentile (days): 4.5

70th percentile (days): 6

85th percentile (days): 9

3 Our Service Level Expectation

A FORECAST FOR ONE ITEM, NOT A TARGET

85% of our items finish within 9 *days.*

Based on how many items, from when to when: the last 10, March to April

The clock starts when: someone pulls it into Building

The clock stops when: it's released to customers

4 Act on Ageing Items

LOOK AT THE OLDEST ITEMS FIRST, EVERY DAY

Past the 50th	Mention it at the daily sync
Past the 70th	Ask what's needed to finish it
Past the 85th	Swarm it (see Buffering & Swarming)

Items to act on today:

- Promo price rules, 10 days: swarm it today
- Billing spike, 8 days: what's needed to finish?
- Order history, 7 days: ask at the sync

"Which item is oldest, and what would it take to finish it today?"

"How long does work usually take here, really?"

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